Abernethy E.S.

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Abernethy would remain open as a neighborhood K-5 school.
- Abernethy would welcome the Buckman student population who live south of Burnside Street.
- Buckman neighborhood students who live south of Burnside St. would move to Abernethy ES.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Enrollment is dropping: Abernethy can hold 441 students, but enrollment is expected to drop to 241 without changes.
- Filling open space: Bringing Buckman and Abernethy student communities together supports a stable size and keeps student enrollment numbers steady.

WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

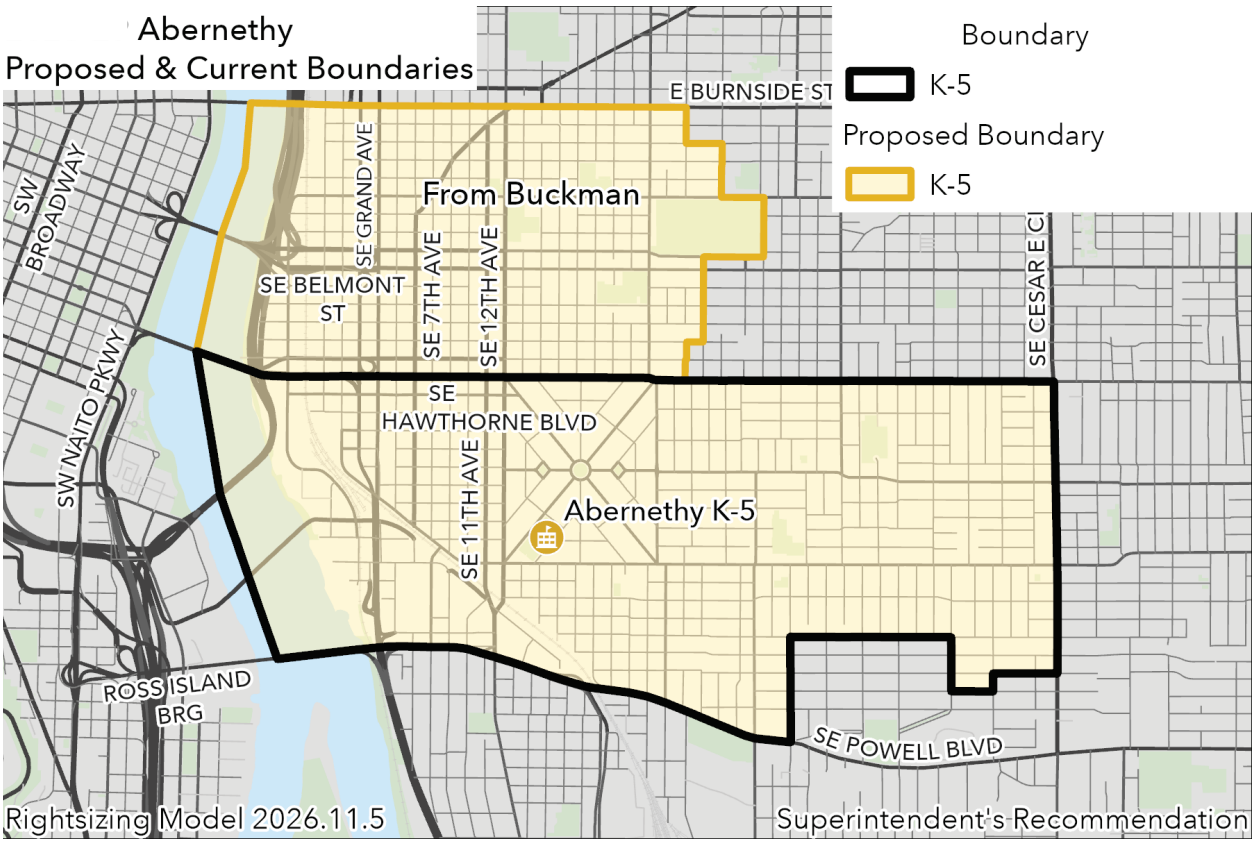
- Abernethy was chosen to stay open because the Buckman building needs urgent, major structural repairs.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- More support and programs: Steady enrollment numbers support stable staffing for classrooms and programs.
- On-site childcare: Families would continue to have access to reliable before- and after-school childcare

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?

Abernethy E.S. boundary



SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Receiving site	441	54.9%	528 (2013-14)	266

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	242	242	247	244	241
Recommendation	312	316	320	317	311

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: K-4th grade students and incoming K students residing in the Buckman attendance area that is south of E Burnside St. will enroll at Abernethy E.S.

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	11.2%	14.5%	1.5%	10.8%	Not Title 1
Recommendation	17%	16.7%	2.9%	13.5%	Not Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Academic Programs: Based on current enrollment projections, there will be two to three classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. Currently, Abernethy and Buckman have blended classrooms in different grade bands. The Academics team will work with educators to plan curriculum for students who are in blends during the 2026-27 school year and may not be during the 2027-28 school year. Students will receive PE, Arts, and Library/Media instruction each week. Based on enrollment, the school will be supported by a full-time counselor.
- Special Education: Currently, Buckman has one Learning Center and two SES classrooms. Abernethy has one Learning Center classroom. Sunnyside has three Learning Center classrooms. With rightsizing, the Buckman SES classrooms will move with much of the Buckman student population to Sunnyside. Sunnyside will now have a projected 3.5 Learning Center FTE and two SES classrooms. Abernethy will maintain a one Learning Center classroom model.
- Student and Family Supports: Currently, both Abernethy and Buckman offer before and after school programming. Our RESJ team is exploring an expansion of childcare capacity at Abernethy. Currently, there is SUN programming at Buckman, but not at Abernethy. Continued SUN programming will depend on County, PPS and City budget processes. Currently, there are no RESJ partners at Buckman or Abernethy. Continuation or expansion of existing partnerships will be dependent on the PPS budget process. Currently, there are no contracted mental health partnerships at Abernethy. Our Student Services team is working with existing mental health partners at the merging sites to ensure continuity of care.

SCHOOL BUILDING INFORMATION

Facility Indicator	Classroom Capacity	Special Education: Dedicated spaces & accessibility	Cafeteria / Nutrition Services	Gymnasium
Readiness	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

TRANSPORTATION

Transportation	2027-2028
Students living within walkable zone – Elementary (1 mile), Middle (1.5 miles)	56.5%
Eligible bus riders	137
Estimated number of routes (not including special ed routes)	4

Transportation	2027-2028
Hazard transportation routes (included in total routes above)	2

REINVESTMENTS FOR RECEIVING SCHOOLS

Schools that receive additional students through consolidation will be allocated a proportion of the total programmatic savings that result from Rightsizing actions. This allocation will be distributed as discretionary FTE that can be used for instructional coaching, academic intervention, school climate support, social work, or duty support. School principals, with consultation from their school communities and approval from their Senior Directors of Instructional Leadership, will determine how to use these additional investments.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.